

@tammyindica

Tammy Silva

Demystifying Interviews: How to prepare?

Strategy

Preparation

Impact

An interview is:

A process

to prove you solve
the job's problem

X An interrogation

X A casual chat

X Your life story

The most common interview mistake

Interviewer asks:

"Have you worked with Excel?"

Bad answer:

"Yes."

The recruiter sees none of this:

Context

Responsibility

Impact

Problem-solving ability

What the recruiter really wants to know

The question is not about the tool. It's about how you work.

1.

What problem you solved

2.

How you identified the problem

3.

What tools you used

4.

How you implemented the solution

5.

Alone or with the team?

6.

What impact you created

A strong answer in practice

Question:

"Have you worked with Excel?"

Strong answer:

"Yes. In my previous role, I noticed our monthly reporting process was extremely manual and time-consuming. I used Excel to build automated reports that reduced the team's manual workload. I worked closely with the finance team to refine the metrics and cut report generation time by around 40%."

Answer elements:

1 Context

2 Problem

3 Solution

4 Collaboration

5 Impact

When you don't have the tool

✗ Bad answer

"No."

Ends the conversation.

✓ Right answer

Honesty

+ similar experience

+ fast learning curve

"I haven't worked specifically with that tool yet. However, in my current role, we use Tool Y, which is very similar in functionality. I believe the learning curve would be quite fast."

How to prepare before the interview

01

Read the job description carefully

02

Identify the main responsibilities

03

Prepare examples from your experience

04

Practice your answers

! Practicing is not memorizing — use bullet points, not a full script

The most valued ones

You don't declare soft skills. You prove them with real stories.

Communication

Organizing ideas and explaining decisions clearly

Ownership

Taking responsibility for results

Collaboration

"I worked with..." / "We solved..."

Adaptability

Maturity to handle shifting priorities

Autonomy

Delivering without constant supervision

Remote interview etiquette

DO

✓ Test audio and camera beforehand

✓ Quiet environment

✓ Good lighting

✓ Camera at eye level

AVOID

X Camera pointing downward

X Dark or messy background

X Looking at another monitor

X Multitasking

At the end of the interview

"Do you have any questions?"

Never answer "No." — smart questions show interest and maturity.

?

"What would success look like in the first six months?"

?

"What are the biggest challenges the team is currently facing?"

I n s u m m a r y

An interview is not improvisation. It's strategy.

Those who come prepared have a huge advantage.

What you did

How you did it

What result it produced

——— Tammy Silva · @tammyindica ———